Customs valuation

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来源ID：SRC-172

原始URL：https://www.customs.gov.sg/doing-business/valuation-duties-and-fees/establishing-customs-value/establishing-customs-value-and-methods/

来源快照核查：2026-11-03；转换日期：2026-11-03

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Establishing Customs Value and Methods

Learn how Singapore Customs determines customs value of imported goods, including the transaction value method, required adjustments, and alternative valuation methods.

Last updated on 12 February 2026

When Customs Value Is Used

Customs value is used to calculate:

Customs duty

Excise duty (for goods with ad valorem rates)

Goods and Services Tax (GST)

Some imports may:

Qualify for preferential tariff treatment

Be exempted from duties under the Customs (Duties Exemption) Order or section 2(1A) of the Customs (Duties) Order

Be exempted from GST

Transaction Value Method

The transaction value method is the primary method used to establish customs value. It is based on the Cost, Insurance and Freight (CIF) value^ under international commercial terms (Incoterms).

To calculate the customs value, you must include all charges incidental to the sale and delivery of the goods to Singapore. Examples of charges to include:

selling commissions

assists (materials provided by the importer)

packing costs

proceeds of resale accruing to the seller

royalties and licence fees

freight charges

insurance charges

Foreign Currency Conversion

If any cost is in a foreign currency, convert it to Singapore Dollars using the prevailing weekly average MAS exchange rates at the time customs duty or excise duty is paid.

Example 1: Import by a company

Company A imports two cartons of vitamins from Supplier B using Ex Works (EXW) incoterms^^.

Cost breakdown for CIF calculation under EXW (Ex Works) incoterms

| Cost component | Amount

| Vitamins | S$1,000

| Selling commission | S$100

| Inland transport to port of export | S$150

| Handling and documentation at port of export | S$200

| Overseas freight | S$300

| Insurance | S$50

Customs value: S$1,800

Example 2: Import by an individual

An individual buys a bag from an overseas seller. A local service provider (B) arranges collection, storage, packing, and shipping, charging a handling fee and overseas freight. No insurance is purchased.

Cost breakdown for CIF calculation for courier shipment without insurance

| Cost component | Amount

| Cost of bag | S$400

| Handling charges | S$20

| Overseas freight | S$30

| Insurance | Nil

Customs value: S$450

All costs incidental to delivery to Singapore must be included for GST purposes.

Definitions of Common Incoterms ^Cost, Insurance and Freight (CIF) incoterms

Under CIF Incoterms:

The seller must:

Deliver the goods onto the vessel at the port of export

Clear the goods for export

Pay international freight

Purchase minimum insurance for the shipment (buyer may arrange extra coverage)

Once the goods are loaded onto the vessel, ownership and risk of loss of the goods are transferred to the buyer. Any claims for loss or damage during transport must be filed by the buyer.

After the goods arrive in Singapore, the buyer must:

Handle customs clearance

Bear all duties, taxes, and other costs

Ex Works (EXW)

Under EXW Incoterms:

The seller makes the goods available at their premises or another named location. Their obligations and risks are minimal.

Once the seller delivers the goods, ownership and risk of loss of the goods are transferred to the buyer.

The buyer is responsible for:

Collection and loading of goods

Export clearance

International transport

Insurance

Import clearance and duties in Singapore

The EXW price does not include:

Transport to port

Loading

Customs clearance at the country of export

Conditions for Using the Transaction Value Method

Singapore Customs will use this method only if all the following conditions are met:

There must be evidence of a sale

Examples of valid documents include:

Commercial invoice

Sales contract

Purchase order

There must be no restriction on the buyer’s use of the goods

The sale is not subject to conditions that may distort the value

For example:

The seller sets the price on condition that the buyer also purchases other goods

The price of semi-finished goods is set on condition that the buyer supplies a portion of the finished goods back to the seller

The relationship between the importer and supplier must not influence the transaction value

Other Valuation Methods

If the transaction value method cannot be used, the following alternatives will be used to determine the customs value:

Identical or similar goods value

Based on the transaction value of identical or similar goods sold for export to Singapore.

Deductive value

Based on the selling price of the goods in Singapore, adjusted for costs incurred after importation.

Computed value

Based on

Production cost

General expenses

Profit in the country of origin of the imported goods

Residual valuation

Based flexibly on the principles of other valuation methods.

Related Information

Flat Rates for Freight and Insurance

Flat Rates for Insurance

Exchange Rates

Transfer Pricing Adjustments on Imports